

AP HuG

Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes



Developing Understanding

BIG IDEA 1

Patterns and Spatial Organization **POO**

- How does where people live and what resources they have access to impact their cultural practices?

BIG IDEA 2

Impacts and Interactions **IMP**

- How does the interaction of people contribute to the spread of cultural practices?

BIG IDEA 3

Spatial Patterns and Societal Change **SPS**

- How and why do cultural ideas, practices, and innovations change or disappear over time?

The main focus of this unit is on cultural patterns and processes that create recognized cultural identities. Students consider the physical environment to determine the effects of geographical location and available resources on cultural practices. Visuals representing artifacts, mentifacts and sociofacts all shed light on cultural landscapes and how they change over time. Practice in analyzing images of different places at different times for evidence of their ethnicity, language, religion, gender roles and attitudes, and other cultural attributes builds students' understanding of cultural patterns and processes.

This unit also considers from a temporal and spatial perspective how culture spreads, through traditional forces such as colonialism and imperialism and through contemporary influences such as social media. Rather than emphasize the details of cultural practices associated with specific languages and religions, this unit instead focuses on the distribution of cultural practices and on the causes and effects of their diffusion. For example, students might study the distribution of Chinese versus English languages or the diffusion patterns of religions such as Hinduism and Islam, at local, national, or global scales.

An understanding of the diffusion of cultural practices provides a foundation for the study of political patterns and processes in the next unit.

Important Dates/Reminders:

AP HuG

Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes

Topic	Learning Objective	Essential Knowledge
3.1 Introduction to Culture	Define the characteristics, attitudes, and traits that influence geographers when they study culture.	Culture comprises the shared practices, technologies, attitudes, and behaviors transmitted by a society. Cultural traits include such things as food preferences, architecture, and land use. Cultural relativism and ethnocentrism are different attitudes toward cultural difference.
3.2 Cultural Landscapes	Describe the characteristics of cultural landscapes. Explain how landscape features and land and resource use reflect cultural beliefs and identities.	Cultural landscapes are combinations of physical features, agricultural and industrial practices, religious and linguistic characteristics, evidence of sequent occupancy, and other expressions of culture including traditional and postmodern architecture and land-use patterns. Attitudes toward ethnicity and gender, including the role of women in the workforce; ethnic neighborhoods; and indigenous communities and lands help shape the use of space in a given society.
3.3 Cultural Patterns	Explain patterns and landscapes of language, religion, ethnicity and gender.	Regional patterns of language, religion, and ethnicity contribute to a sense of place, enhance placemaking, and shape the global cultural landscape. Language, ethnicity, and religion are factors in creating centripetal and centrifugal forces.
3.4 Population Dynamics	Define the types of diffusion.	Relocation and expansion – including contagious, hierarchical and stimulus expansion – are types of diffusion.
3.5 Historical Causes of Diffusion	Explain how historical processes impact current cultural patterns.	Interactions between and among cultural traits and larger global forces can lead to new forms of cultural expression; for example, creolization and lingua franca.
3.6 Contemporary Causes of Diffusion	Explain how historical processes impact current cultural patterns.	Cultural ideas and practices are socially constructed and change through both small-scale and large-scale processes such as urbanization and globalization. These processes come to bear on culture through media, technological change, politics, economics and social relationships. Communication technologies, such as the internet and the time-space convergence, are reshaping and accelerating interactions among people, changing cultural practices, as in the increasing use of English and the loss of indigenous languages, and creating cultural convergence and divergence.
3.7 Diffusion of Religion and Language	Explain what factors lead to the diffusion of universalizing and ethnic religions.	Language families, languages, dialects, world religions, ethnic cultures, and gender roles diffuse from cultural hearths. Diffusion of language families, including Indo-European, and religious patterns and distributions can be visually represented on maps, in charts and toponyms, and in other representations. Religions have distinct places of origin from which they diffused to other locations through different processes. Practices and belief systems impacted how widespread the religion diffused. Universalizing religions, including Christianity, Islam, Buddhism, and Sikhism, are spread through expansion and relocation diffusion. Ethnic religions, including Hinduism and Judaism, are generally found near the hearth or spread through relocation diffusion.
3.8 Effects of Diffusion	Explain how the process of diffusion results in changes to the cultural landscape.	Acculturation, assimilation, syncretism, and multiculturalism are effects of the diffusion of culture.

Chapter 4: Local Culture, Popular Culture, and Cultural Landscapes Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes Questions/Main Ideas:	Name: _____ Class: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____ Notes/Answers:
Field Note (pg. 90 & 91)	
Why are Chinatown and Little Italy good examples of a cultural landscape?	

Key Q #1: What are local and popular cultures? (pg. 91 - 93)	
Compare and contrast folk and popular culture. Provide multiple characteristics, traits, and examples.	

Key Q #3: How is popular culture diffused? (pg. 102 - 110)	
How is popular culture diffused?	
How is a hearth established? How is a hearth manufactured?	
Using Figures 4.15a and 4.15b on page 104, compare and contrast distance decay and time-space compression.	
Describe the hearth and diffusion of Hip Hop.	

Which countries exert the greatest influence on popular culture?

Key Q #4: How can local and popular cultures be seen in the cultural landscape? (pg. 111 - 115)

How can we see cultural traits in the landscape? Provide multiple examples.

What are the three developments at the heart of the convergence of globalization and cultural diffusion? Describe all three.

Describe the cultural landscape of the Mormon population in Utah.

Chapter 5: Identity: Race, Ethnicity, Gender, and Sexuality Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes Questions/Main Ideas:	Name: _____ Class: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____ Notes/Answers:
Field Note (pg. 117 - 118)	
Define <i>gender</i> in terms of geographers Mona Domosh and Joni Seager.	
Why do some poorer countries hire women over men?	
Describe the “boxes” societies create in regard to stereotypes and assumptions.	

Key Q #1: What is identity, and how are our identities constructed? (pg. 119 - 127)	
How are our identities constructed?	
What does it mean to identify against other people?	
Why is race considered a social construct?	
Summarize Benjamin Forest's global overview of race.	
How has the definition of “race” changed in the United States? Use the classification of “Hispanic” as an example.	

What is residential segregation according to Massey and Denton?	
What could happen to the cultural landscape of a neighborhood undergoing succession?	
How does the cultural landscape of New York City reflect its population?	

Key Q #2: How do places affect identity, and how can we see identities in places? (pg. 127 - 130)	
Describe an example of how ethnic identity can be affected by scale.	
How can we see sexuality in a place?	
How might the map in Figure 5.10 change if sexuality were one of the "boxes" every person filled out on the census	

Chapter 6: Language Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes Questions/Main Ideas:	Name: _____ Class: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____ Notes/Answers:
Field Note (pg. 143 - 146)	
Using information from the introduction, how can language maps be deceiving or inaccurate?	
How can language be divisive?	
Describe the “boxes” societies create in regard to stereotypes and assumptions.	
Key Q #2: Why are languages distributed the way they are? (pg. 152 - 160)	
Using the map in Figure 6.8, what language family does English come from? What region of the world share this family?	
How do new languages form and other languages die?	
Based on the language tree, what branch do you find English?	
Describe the route of diffusion of the Indo-European language?	
How much of the world speaks an Indo-European tongue?	

Describe the three major subfamilies of European linguistics.	• Romance: • Germanic: • Slavic:
Analyze the map in Figure 6.14. What trends do you see? What do you think caused these trends?	
How many languages are spoken in Nigeria? What role does English play in Nigerian culture and society?	

Key Q #3: How did certain languages become dominant? (pg. 161 - 164)

How did certain languages become dominant?	
Define <i>lingua franca</i> . How is it used today?	
What is a <i>pidgin language</i> ? Provide an example.	
Describe the relationship between official languages and colonization.	
How do international organizations accommodate their member countries when it comes to language?	
What information does the text use to support the argument that English will become the global language?	

Chapter 7: Religion Unit 3: Cultural Patterns & Processes Questions/Main Ideas:	Name: _____ Class: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____ Notes/Answers:
Field Note (pg. 171 - 172)	
What is an interface area? Describe what it's like to live in the interface area in Belfast.	
Key Q #2: Where did the major religions of the world originate, and how do religions diffuse? (pg. 175 - 190)	
Describe the three categories of religion:	● Monotheistic: ● Polytheistic: ● Animistic:
What were almost all religions like for most of human history? How did Zoroastrianism change that?	
Describe the four major religious hearths:	● South Asia: ● Eastern Mediterranean: ● Huang He River Valley: ● Northern Mediterranean:
What is the difference between a universalizing religion and an ethnic religion? Provide an example of each.	

Describe the main tenets and diffusion of each religion:

- Hinduism:
 - What is the caste system?
- Buddhism:
- Shintoism:
- Taoism:
- Confucianism:
- Judaism:
 - Describe the Zionism movement.
- Christianity:
 - What is the difference between the Eastern Orthodox Church and the Roman Catholic Church?

	● Islam: ○ What is the difference between the Sunni and Shi'ite Muslims? ● Shamanism: ● Secularism:
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Key Q #3: How is religion seen in the cultural landscape? (pg. 190 - 200)	
Describe the cultural landscape of the following in terms of religion:	● Jerusalem: ● Hinduism: ● Buddhism: ● Christianity: ● Islam: